

Guidelines



Guidelines 01/2020 on processing personal data in the context of connected vehicles and mobility related applications

Version 2.0

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The European Data Protection Board

Having regard to Article 70 (1) (e) of the Regulation 2016/679/EU of the European Parliament and of the Council of 27 April 2016 on the protection of natural persons with regard to the processing of personal data and on the free movement of such data, and repealing Directive 95/46/EC, (hereinafter “GDPR”),

Having regard to the EEA Agreement and in particular to Annex XI and Protocol 37 thereof, as amended by the Decision of the EEA joint Committee No 154/2018 of 6 July 2018¹,

Having regard to Article 12 and Article 22 of its Rules of Procedure,

HAS ADOPTED THE FOLLOWING GUIDELINES

1 INTRODUCTION

1. Symbol of the 20th century economy, the automobile is one of the mass consumer products that has impacted society as a whole. Commonly associated with the notion of freedom, cars are often considered as more than just a means of transportation. Indeed, they represent a private area in which people can enjoy a form of autonomy of decision, without encountering any external interferences. Today, as connected vehicles move into the mainstream, such a vision no longer corresponds to the reality. In-vehicle connectivity is rapidly expanding from luxury models and premium brands to high-volume midmarket models, and vehicles are becoming massive data hubs. Not only vehicles, but drivers and passengers are also becoming more and more connected. As a matter of fact, many models launched over the past few years on the market integrate sensors and connected on-board equipment, which may collect and record, among other things, the engine performance, the driving habits, the locations visited, and potentially even the driver’s eye movements, his or her pulse, or biometric data for the purpose of uniquely identifying a natural person.²
2. Such data processing is taking place in a complex ecosystem, which is not limited to the traditional players of the automotive industry, but is also shaped by the emergence of new players belonging to the digital economy. These new players may offer infotainment services such as online music, road condition and traffic information, or provide driving assistance systems and services, such as autopilot software, vehicle condition updates, usage-based insurance or dynamic mapping. Moreover, since vehicles are connected via electronic communication networks, road infrastructure managers and telecommunications operators involved in this process also play an important role with respect to the potential processing operations applied to the drivers’ and passengers’ personal data.
3. In addition, connected vehicles are generating increasing amounts of data, most of which can be considered personal data since they will relate to drivers or passengers. Even if the

¹ References to “Member States” made throughout this document should be understood as references to “EEA Member States”.

² Infographic “Data and the connected car” by the Future of Privacy Forum; https://fpf.org/wp-content/uploads/2017/06/2017_0627-FPF-Connected-Car-Infographic-Version-1.0.pdf

data collected by a connected car are not directly linked to a name, but to technical aspects and features of the vehicle, it will concern the driver or the passengers of the car. As an illustration, data relating to the driving style or the distance covered, data relating to the wear and tear on vehicle parts, location data or data collected by cameras may concern driver behaviour as well as information about other people who could be inside or data subjects that pass by. Such technical data are produced by a natural person, and permit his/her direct or indirect identification, by the data controller or by another person. The vehicle can be considered as a terminal that can be used by different users. Therefore, as for a personal computer, this potential plurality of users does not affect the personal nature of the data.

4. In 2016, the Fédération Internationale de l'Automobile (FIA) ran a campaign across Europe called "My Car My Data" to get a sentiment on what Europeans think about connected cars.³ While it showed the high interest of drivers for connectivity, it also highlighted the vigilance that must be exercised with regard to the use of the data produced by vehicles as well as the importance of complying with personal data protection legislation. Thus, the challenge is, for each stakeholder, to incorporate the "protection of personal data" dimension from the product design phase, and to ensure that car users enjoy transparency and control in relation to their data in accordance with recital 78 GDPR. Such an approach helps to strengthen user confidence, and thus the long-term development of those technologies.

1.1 Related works

5. Connected vehicles have become a substantial subject for regulators over the last decade, with a major increase in the last couple of years. Various works have thus been published at the national and international levels concerning the security and privacy of connected vehicles. Those regulations and initiatives aim at complementing the existing data protection and privacy frameworks with sector specific rules or providing guidance to professionals.

1.1.1 European-level and international initiatives

6. Since 31 March 2018, a 112-based eCall in-vehicle system is mandatory on all new types of M1 and N1 vehicles (passenger cars and light duty vehicles).^{4,5} In 2006, the Article 29 Working Party had already adopted a working document on data protection and privacy implications in eCall initiative.⁶ In addition, as previously discussed, the Article 29 Working Party also adopted an opinion in October 2017 regarding the processing of personal data in the context of Cooperative Intelligent Transport Systems (C-ITS).
7. In January 2017, the European Union Agency for Network and Information Security (ENISA) published a study focused on cyber security and resilience of smart cars listing the sensitive assets as well as the corresponding threats, risks, mitigation factors and possible security

³ Campaign "My Car My Data"; <http://www.mycarmydata.eu/>.

⁴ The interoperable EU-wide eCall; https://ec.europa.eu/transport/themes/its/road/action_plan/ecall_en.

⁵ Decision No 585/2014/EU of the European Parliament and of the Council of 15 May 2014 on the deployment of the interoperable EU-wide eCall service Text with EEA relevance; <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/PDF/?uri=CELEX:32014D0585>.

⁶ Working document on data protection and privacy implications in eCall initiative; http://ec.europa.eu/justice/article-29/documentation/opinion-recommendation/files/2006/wp125_en.pdf.

measures to implement.⁷ In September 2017, the International Conference of Data Protection and Privacy Commissioners (ICDPPC) adopted a resolution on connected vehicles.⁸ Finally, in April 2018, the International Working Group on Data Protection in Telecommunications (IWGDPT), also adopted a working paper on connected vehicles.⁹

1.1.2 National initiatives of European Data Protection Board (EDPB) members

8. In January 2016, the Conference of the German Federal and State Data Protection Authorities and the German Association of the Automotive Industry (VDA) published a common declaration on the principles of data protection in connected and not-connected vehicles.¹⁰ In August 2017, the UK Centre for Connected and Autonomous Vehicles (CCAV) released a guide stating principles of cyber security for connected and automated vehicles in order to raise awareness on the matter within the automotive sector.¹¹ In October 2017, the French data protection authority, the Commission Nationale de l'Informatique et des Libertés (CNIL), released a compliance package for connected cars in order to provide assistance to stakeholders on how to integrate data protection by design and by default, enabling data subjects to have effective control over their data.¹²

1.2 Applicable law

9. The relevant EU legal framework is the GDPR. It applies in any case where data processing in the context of connected vehicles involves processing personal data of individuals.
10. Additionally to the GDPR, directive 2002/58/EC as revised by 2009/136/EC (hereinafter – “ePrivacy directive”), **sets a specific standard for all actors that wish to store or access information stored in the terminal equipment of a subscriber or user in the European Economic Area (EEA).**
11. Indeed, if most of the ePrivacy directive provisions (art. 6, art. 9, etc.) only apply to providers of publicly available electronic communication services and providers of public communication networks, art. 5(3) ePrivacy directive is a general provision. It does not only apply to electronic communication services but also to every entity, private or public, that places on or reads information from a terminal equipment without regard to the nature of the data being stored or accessed.

⁷ Cyber security and resilience of smart cars; <https://www.enisa.europa.eu/publications/cyber-security-and-resilience-of-smart-cars>.

⁸ Resolution on data protection in automated and connected vehicles; https://edps.europa.eu/sites/edp/files/publication/resolution-on-data-protection-in-automated-and-connected-vehicles_en_1.pdf.

⁹ Working paper on connected vehicles; <https://www.datenschutz-berlin.de/infothek-und-service/veroeffentlichungen/working-paper/>.

¹⁰ Data protection aspects of using connected and non-connected vehicles; https://www.lda.bayern.de/media/dsk_joint_statement_vda.pdf.

¹¹ Principles of cyber security for connected and automated vehicles; <https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/principles-of-cyber-security-for-connected-and-automated-vehicles>.

¹² Compliance package for a responsible use of data in connected cars; <https://www.cnil.fr/en/connected-vehicles-compliance-package-responsible-use-data>.

12. Regarding the notion of “*terminal equipment*”, the definition is given by directive 2008/63/CE¹³. Art. 1 (a) defines the terminal equipment as an “*equipment directly or indirectly connected to the interface of a public telecommunications network to send, process or receive information; in either case (direct or indirect), the connection may be made by wire, optical fibre or electromagnetically; a connection is indirect if equipment is placed between the terminal and the interface of the network; (b) satellite earth station equipment*”.
13. As a result, provided that the aforementioned criteria are met, the connected vehicle and device connected to it should be considered as a “*terminal equipment*” (just like a computer, a smartphone or a smart TV) and provisions of art. 5(3) ePrivacy directive apply where relevant.
14. As outlined by the EDPB in its opinion 5/2019 on the interplay between the ePrivacy directive and the GDPR,¹⁴ art. 5(3) ePrivacy directive provides that, as a rule, and subject to the exceptions to that rule mentioned in paragraph 17 below, prior consent is required for the storing of information, or the gaining of access to information already stored, in the terminal equipment of a subscriber or user. To the extent that the information stored in the end-user’s device constitutes personal data, art. 5(3) ePrivacy directive shall take precedence over art. 6 GDPR with regards to the activity of storing or gaining access to this information.¹⁵ Any processing operations of personal data following the aforementioned processing operations, including processing personal data obtained by accessing information in the terminal equipment, must have a legal basis under art. 6 GDPR in order to be lawful.¹⁶
15. Since the controller, when seeking consent for the storing or gaining of access to information pursuant to art. 5(3) ePrivacy directive, will have to inform the data subject about all the purposes of the processing – including any processing following the aforementioned operations (meaning the “subsequent processing”) – consent under art. 6 GDPR will generally be the most adequate legal basis to cover the processing of personal data following such operations (as far as the purpose of the following processing is comprehended by the data subject’s consent, see paragraphs 53-54 below). Hence, consent will likely constitute the legal basis both for the storing and gaining of access to information already stored and the subsequent processing of personal data¹⁷. Indeed, when assessing compliance with art. 6 GDPR, one should take into account that the processing as a whole involves specific activities for which the EU legislature has sought to provide additional protection.¹⁸ Moreover, controllers must take into account the impact on data subjects’

¹³ Commission Directive 2008/63/EC of 20 June 2008 on competition in the markets in telecommunications terminal equipment (Codified version) (Text with EEA relevance); <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/ALL/?uri=CELEX%3A32008L0063>.

¹⁴ European Data Protection Board, Opinion 5/2019 on the interplay between the ePrivacy Directive and the GDPR, in particular regarding the competence, tasks and powers of data protection authorities, adopted on 12 March 2019 (hereinafter - “Opinion 5/2019”), paragraph 40.

¹⁵ Ibid, paragraph 40.

¹⁶ Ibid, paragraph 41.

¹⁷ Consent required by art. 5(3) of the “ePrivacy” directive and consent needed as a legal basis for the processing of data (art. 6 GDPR) for the same specific purpose can be collected at the same time (for example, by checking a box clearly indicating what the data subject is consenting to).

¹⁸ Opinion 5/2019, paragraph 41.

rights when identifying the appropriate lawful basis in order to respect the principle of fairness.¹⁹ The bottom line is that art. 6 GDPR cannot be relied upon by controllers in order to lower the additional protection provided by art. 5(3) ePrivacy directive.

16. The EDPB recalls that the notion of consent in the ePrivacy directive remains the notion of consent in the GDPR and must meet all the requirements of the consent as provided by art. 4(11) and 7 GDPR.
17. However, while consent is the principle, art. 5(3) ePrivacy directive allows the storing of information or the gaining of access to information that is already stored in the terminal equipment to be exempted from the requirement of informed consent, if it satisfies one of the following criteria:
 -)] **Exemption 1:** for the sole purpose of carrying out the transmission of a communication over an electronic communications network;
 -)] **Exemption 2:** when it is strictly necessary in order for the provider of an information society service explicitly requested by the subscriber or user to provide the service.
18. In such cases, the processing of personal data including personal data obtained by accessing information in the terminal equipment is based on one of the legal bases as provided by art. 6 GDPR. For example, consent is not needed when data processing is necessary to provide GPS navigation services requested by the data subject when such services can be qualified as information society services.

1.3 Scope

19. The EDPB would like to point out that these guidelines are intended to facilitate compliance of the processing of personal data carried out by a wide range of stakeholders working in this environment. However, they are not intended to cover all use cases possible in this context or to provide guidance for every possible specific situation.
20. The scope of this document focuses in particular on the personal data processing in relation to the non-professional use of connected vehicles by data subjects: e.g., drivers, passengers, vehicle owners, other road users, etc. More specifically, it deals with the personal data: (i) processed inside the vehicle, (ii) exchanged between the vehicle and personal devices connected to it (e.g., the user's smartphone) or (iii) collected locally in the vehicle and exported to external entities (e.g., vehicle manufacturers, infrastructure managers, insurance companies, car repairers) for further processing.
21. The connected vehicle definition has to be understood as a broad concept in this document. It can be defined as a vehicle equipped with many electronic control units (ECU) that are linked together via an in-vehicle network as well as connectivity facilities allowing it to share information with other devices both inside and outside the vehicle. As such, data can be exchanged between the vehicle and personal devices connected to it, for instance allowing the mirroring of mobile applications to the car's in-dash information and entertainment unit. Also, the development of standalone mobile applications, meaning independent of the vehicle (for example, relying on the sole use of the smart phone) to assist drivers is included

¹⁹ European Data Protection Board, [Guidelines 2/2019 on the processing of personal data under Article 6\(1\)\(b\) GDPR in the context of the provision of online services to data subjects](#), Version 2.0, 8 October 2019, paragraph 1.

in the scope of this document since they contribute to the vehicle's connectivity capacities even though they may not effectively rely on the transmission of data with the vehicle *per se*. Applications for connected vehicles are multiple and diverse and can include²⁰:

22. *Mobility management*: functions that allow drivers to reach a destination quickly, and in a cost-efficient manner, by providing timely information about GPS navigation, potentially dangerous environmental conditions (e.g., icy roads), traffic congestion or road construction work, parking lot or garage assistance, optimised fuel consumption or road pricing.
23. *Vehicle management*: functions that are supposed to aid drivers in reducing operating costs and improving ease of use, such as notification of vehicle condition and service reminders, transfer of usage data (e.g., for vehicle repair services), customised "*Pay As/How You Drive*" insurances, remote operations (e.g., heating system) or profile configurations (e.g., seat position).
24. *Road safety*: functions that warn the driver of external hazards and internal responses, such as collision protection, hazard warnings, lane departure warnings, driver drowsiness detection, emergency call (eCall) or crash investigation "black-boxes" (event data recorder).
25. *Entertainment*: functions providing information to and involving the entertainment of the driver and passengers, such as smart phone interfaces (hands free phone calls, voice generated text messages), WLAN hot spots, music, video, Internet, social media, mobile office or "smart home" services.
26. *Driver assistance*: functions involving partially or fully automated driving, such as operational assistance or autopilot in heavy traffic, in parking, or on highways,
27. *Well-being*: functions monitoring the driver's comfort, ability and fitness to drive such as fatigue detection or medical assistance.
28. Hence, vehicles can be natively connected or not and personal data can be collected through several means, including: (i) vehicle sensors, (ii) telematics boxes or (iii) mobile applications (e.g. accessed from a device belonging to a driver). In order to fall within the scope of this document, mobile applications need to be related to the environment of driving. For example, GPS navigation applications are in-scope. Applications whose functionalities only suggest places of interest (restaurants, historic monument, etc.) to drivers fall, however, outside the scope of these guidelines.
29. Much of the data that is generated by a connected vehicle relate to a natural person that is identified or identifiable and thus constitute personal data. For instance, data include directly identifiable data (e.g., the driver's complete identity), as well as indirectly identifiable data such as the details of journeys made, the vehicle usage data (e.g., data relating to driving style or the distance covered), or the vehicle's technical data (e.g., data relating to the wear and tear on vehicle parts), which, by cross-referencing with other files and especially the vehicle identification number (VIN), can be related to a natural person. Personal data in connected vehicles can also include metadata, such as vehicle maintenance status. In other words, any data that can be associated with a natural person therefore fall into the scope of this document.

²⁰ PwC Strategy 2014. "In the fast lane. The bright future of connected cars":
https://www.strategyand.pwc.com/media/file/Strategyand_In-the-Fast-Lane.pdf.

30. The connected vehicle ecosystem covers a wide spectrum of stakeholders. This ecosystem more precisely includes traditional actors of the automotive industry as well as emerging players from the digital industry. Hence, these guidelines are directed towards vehicle manufacturers, equipment manufacturers and automotive suppliers, car repairers, automobile dealerships, vehicle service providers, fleet managers, motor insurance companies, entertainment providers, telecommunication operators, road infrastructure managers and public authorities as well as data subjects. The EDPB underlines that the categories of data subjects will differ from one service to another (e.g., drivers, owners, passengers, etc.). This is a non-exhaustive list as the ecosystem entails a wide variety of services, including services for which a direct authentication or identification is needed and services for which this is not needed.
31. Some data processing performed by natural persons within the vehicle fall within “*the course of a purely personal or household activity*” and are consequently out of the scope of the GDPR²¹. In particular, this concerns the use of personal data within the vehicles by the sole data subjects who provided such data into the vehicle’s dashboard. However, the EDPB recalls that according to its recital 18 the GDPR “*applies to controllers or processors which provide the means for processing personal data for such personal or household activities*”.

1.3.1 Out of scope of this document

32. Employers providing company cars to members of their staff might want to monitor their employee’s actions (e.g., in order to ensure the safety of the employee, goods or vehicles, to allocate resources, to track and bill a service or to check working time). Data processing carried out by employers in this context raises specific considerations to the employment context, which might be regulated by labour laws at the national level that cannot be detailed in these guidelines²².
33. While the data processing in the context of commercial vehicles used for professional purposes (such as public transport) and shared transport and MaaS solution may raise specific considerations which fall out of the scope of these general guidelines, many of the principles and recommendations set out here will also be applicable to those types of processing.
34. Connected vehicles being radio-enabled systems, they are subject to passive tracking such as Wi-Fi or Bluetooth tracking. In that sense they do not differ from other connected devices and fall in the scope of the ePrivacy directive which is currently being revised. This therefore excludes also large-scale tracking of Wi-Fi equipped vehicles²³ by a dense network of bystanders who use common smartphone location services. These routinely report all visible Wi-Fi networks to central servers. Since built-in Wi-Fi can be considered a secondary vehicle

²¹ See GDPR, Article 2(2)(c).

²² The Article 29 Working Party elaborated on this in its WP249 Opinion 2/2017 on data processing at work; https://ec.europa.eu/newsroom/article29/item-detail.cfm?item_id=610169.

²³ See for details: <https://www.datenschutzzentrum.de/artikel/1269-Location-Services-can-Systematically-Track-Vehicles-with-WiFi-Access-Points-at-Large-Scale.html>.

identifier²⁴, this risks a systematic ongoing collection of complete vehicle movement profiles.

35. Vehicles are increasingly equipped with image recording devices (e.g., car parking camera systems or dashcams). Since this deals with the issue of filming public places, which requires an assessment of the relevant legislative framework which is specific to each Member State, this data processing is out of the scope of these guidelines.
36. The processing of data enabling Cooperative Intelligent Transport Systems (C-ITS) – as defined in the directive 2010/40/EU²⁵ has been dealt with in a specific opinion by the Article 29 Working Party²⁶. While the definition of the C-ITS concept in the directive does not bear any technical specifications, the Article 29 Working Party focuses in its opinion on short-range communications, i.e. that do not involve the intervention of a network operator. More specifically, it provides analysis for specific use cases built for initial deployment and committed to assess at a later stage the new issues that will be undoubtedly raised when higher level of automation will be implemented. Since the data protection implications in the context of C-ITS are very specific (unprecedented amounts of location data, continuous broadcasting of personal data, exchange of data between vehicles and other road infrastructural facilities, etc.) and that it is still being discussed at the European level, the processing of personal data in that context is not covered by these guidelines.
37. Finally, this document does not aim to address all possible issues and questions raised by connected vehicles and can therefore not be considered as exhaustive.

1.4 Definitions

38. The **processing** of personal data encompasses any operation that involves personal data such as collection, recording, organisation, structuring, storage, adaptation or alteration, retrieval, consultation, use, disclosure by transmission, dissemination or otherwise making available, alignment or combination, restriction, erasure or destruction, etc.²⁷
39. The **data subject** is the natural person to whom the data covered by the processing relate. In the context of connected vehicles, it can, in particular, be the driver (main or occasional), the passenger, or the owner of the vehicle.²⁸
40. The **data controller** is the person who determines the purposes and means of processing that take place in connected vehicles.²⁹ Data controllers can include service providers that process vehicle data to send the driver traffic-information, eco-driving messages or alerts

²⁴ Markus Ullmann, Tobias Franz, and Gerd Nolden, Vehicle Identification Based on Secondary Vehicle Identifier -- Analysis, and Measurements, in Proceedings, VEHICULAR 2017, The Sixth International Conference on Advances in Vehicular Systems, Technologies and Applications, Nice, France, July 23 to 27, 2017, p. 32-37.

²⁵ Directive 2010/40/EU of 7 July 2020 on the framework for the deployment of Intelligent Transport Systems in the field of road transport and for interfaces with other modes of transport; <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/PDF/?uri=CELEX:32010L0040>.

²⁶ Article 29 Working Party - Opinion 03/2017 on Processing personal data in the context of Cooperative Intelligent Transport Systems (C-ITS); http://ec.europa.eu/newsroom/article29/item-detail.cfm?item_id=610171.

²⁷ See GDPR, Article 4 (2).

²⁸ See GDPR, Article 4 (1).

²⁹ See GDPR, Article 4 (7) and the European Data Protection Board, [Guidelines 07/2020 on the concepts of controller and processor in the GDPR](#) (hereinafter - "Guidelines 07/2020").

regarding the functioning of the vehicle, insurance companies offering “Pay As You Drive” contracts, or vehicle manufacturers gathering data on the wear and tear affecting the vehicle’s parts to improve its quality. Pursuant to art. 26 GDPR, two or more controllers can jointly determine the purposes and means of the processing and thus be considered as joint controllers. In this case, they have to clearly define their respective obligations, especially as regards the exercising of the rights of data subjects and the provision of information as referred to in art. 13 and 14 GDPR.

41. The **data processor** is any person who processes personal data for and on behalf of the data controller.³⁰ The data processor collects and processes data on instruction from the data controller, without using those data for its own purposes. As an example, in a number of cases, equipment manufacturers and automotive suppliers may process data on behalf of vehicle manufacturers (which does not imply they cannot be a data controller for other purposes). In addition to requiring data processors to implement appropriate technical and organisational measures in order to guarantee a security level that is adapted to risk, art. 28 GDPR sets out data processors’ obligations.
42. The **recipient** means a natural or legal person, public authority, agency or another body, to which the personal data are disclosed, whether a third party or not.³¹ As an example, a commercial partner of the service provider that receives from the service provider personal data generated from the vehicle is a recipient of personal data. Whether they act as a new data controller or as a data processor, they shall comply with all the obligations imposed by the GDPR.
43. However, public authorities which may receive personal data in the framework of a particular inquiry in accordance with Union or Member State law shall not be regarded as recipients³²; the processing of those data by those public authorities shall be in compliance with the applicable data protection rules according to the purposes of the processing. As an example, law enforcement authorities are authorised third parties when they request personal data as part of an investigation in accordance with European Union or Member State law.

³⁰ See GDPR, Article 4 (8) and the Guidelines 07/2020.

³¹ See GDPR, Article 4 (9) and the Guidelines 07/2020.

³² GDPR, Article 4 (9) and Recital 31.

1.5 Privacy and data protection risks

44. Article 29 Working Party has already expressed several concerns about Internet of Things (IoT) systems that can also apply to connected vehicles.³³ The issues relating to data security and control already stressed regarding IoT are even more sensitive in the context of connected vehicles, since it entails road safety concerns – and can impact the physical integrity of the driver – in an environment traditionally perceived as isolated and protected from external interferences.
45. Also, connected vehicles raises significant data protection and privacy concerns regarding the processing of location data as its increasingly intrusive nature can put a strain on the current possibilities to remain anonymous. The EDPB wants to place particular emphasis and raise stakeholders' awareness to the fact that the use of location technologies requires the implementation of specific safeguards in order to prevent surveillance of individuals and misuse of the data.

1.5.1 Lack of control and information asymmetry

46. Vehicle drivers and passengers may not always be adequately informed about the processing of data taking place in or through a connected vehicle. The information may be given only to the vehicle owner, who may not be the driver, and may also not be provided in a timely fashion. Thus, there is a risk that there are insufficient functionalities or options offered to exercise the control necessary for affected individuals to avail themselves of their data protection and privacy rights. This point is of importance since, during their lifetime, vehicles may belong to more than one owner either because they are sold or because they are being leased rather than purchased.
47. Also, communication in the vehicle can be triggered automatically as well as by default, without the individual being aware of it. In the absence of the possibility to effectively control how the vehicle and its connected equipment interact, it is bound to become extraordinarily difficult for the user to control the flow of data. It will be even more difficult to control its subsequent use, and thereby prevent potential function creep.

1.5.2 Quality of the user's consent

48. The EDPB underlines that, when the data processing is based on consent, all elements of valid consent have to be met which means that consent shall be free, specific and informed and constitutes an unambiguous indication of the data subject's wishes as interpreted in EDPB guidelines on consent.³⁴ Data controllers need to pay careful attention to the modalities of obtaining valid consent from different participants, such as car owners or car users. Such consent must be provided separately, for specific purposes and may not be bundled with the contract to buy or lease a new car. Consent must be as easily withdrawn as it is given.
49. The same has to be applied when consent is required to comply with the ePrivacy directive, for example if there is a storing of information or the gaining of access to information already stored in the vehicle as required in certain cases by art. 5(3) of the ePrivacy directive. Indeed, as outlined above, consent in this context has to be interpreted in light of the GDPR.

³³ Article 29 Working Party – Opinion 8/2014 on the Recent Developments on the Internet of Things; https://ec.europa.eu/justice/article-29/documentation/opinion-recommendation/files/2014/wp223_en.pdf.

³⁴ European Data Protection Board, Guidelines 05/2020 on consent under Regulation 2016/679, Version 1.1, 4 May 2020 (hereinafter - "Guidelines 05/2020").

50. In many cases, the user may not be aware of the data processing carried out in his/her vehicle. Such lack of information constitutes a significant barrier to demonstrating valid consent under the GDPR, as the consent must be informed. In such circumstances, consent cannot be relied upon as a legal basis for the corresponding data processing under the GDPR.
51. Classic mechanisms used to obtain individuals' consent may be difficult to apply in the context of connected vehicles, resulting in a "low-quality" consent based on a lack of information or in the factual impossibility to provide fine-tuned consent in line with the preferences expressed by individuals. In practice, consent might also be difficult to obtain for drivers and passengers who are not related to the vehicle's owner in the case of second-hand, leased, rented or borrowed vehicles.
52. When the ePrivacy directive does not require the data subject consent, the controller nonetheless has the responsibility of choosing the legal basis under art. 6 GDPR that is most appropriate to the case for the processing of personal data.

1.5.3 Further processing of personal data

53. When data is collected on the basis of consent as required by art. 5(3) of the ePrivacy directive or on one of the exemptions of art. 5(3), and subsequently processed in accordance with art. 6 GDPR, it can only be further processed either if the controller seeks additional consent for this other purpose or if the data controller can demonstrate that it is based on a Union or Member State law to safeguard the objectives referred to in art. 23 (1) GDPR³⁵. The EDPB considers that further processing on the basis of a compatibility test according to art. 6(4) GDPR is not possible in such cases, since it would undermine the data protection standard of the ePrivacy directive. Indeed, consent, where required under the ePrivacy directive, needs to be specific and informed, meaning that data subjects must be aware of each data processing purpose and entitled to refuse specific ones³⁶. Considering that further processing on the basis of a compatibility test according to art. 6(4) of the GDPR is possible would circumvent the very principle of the consent requirements set forth by the current directive.
54. The EDPB recalls that the initial consent will never legitimise further processing as consent needs to be informed and specific to be valid.
55. For instance, telemetry data, which is collected during use of the vehicle for maintenance purposes may not be disclosed to motor insurance companies without the users consent for the purpose of creating driver profiles to offer driving behaviour-based insurance policies.
56. Furthermore, data collected by connected vehicles may be processed by law enforcement authorities to detect speeding or other infractions if and when the specific conditions in the law enforcement directive are fulfilled. In this case, such data will be considered as relating to criminal convictions and offences under the conditions laid down by art. 10 GDPR and any applicable national legislation. Manufacturers may provide the law enforcement authorities with such data if the specific conditions for such processing are fulfilled. The EDPB points out that processing of personal data for the sole purpose of fulfilling requests made by law enforcement authorities does not constitute a specified, explicit and legitimate purpose within the meaning of art. 5(1)(b) GDPR. When law enforcement authorities are authorized by law, they could be third parties within the meaning of art. 4(10) GDPR, in this case

³⁵ See also European Data Protection Board, Guidelines 10/2020 on restrictions under Article 23 GDPR.

³⁶ Guidelines 05/2020, sections 3.2 and 3.3.

manufacturers would be entitled to provide them with any data at their disposal subject to compliance with the relevant legal framework in each Member State.

1.5.4 Excessive data collection

57. With the ever-increasing number of sensors being deployed in connected vehicles there is a very high risk of excessive data collection compared to what is necessary to achieve the purpose.
58. The development of new functionalities and more specifically those based on machine learning algorithms may require a large amount of data collected over a long period of time.

1.5.5 Security of personal data

59. The plurality of functionalities, services and interfaces (e.g., web, USB, RFID, Wi-Fi) offered by connected vehicles increases the attack surface and thus the number of potential vulnerabilities through which personal data could be compromised. Unlike most IoT devices, connected vehicles are critical systems where a security breach may endanger the life of its users and people around. The importance of addressing the risk of hackers attempting to exploit connected vehicles' vulnerabilities is thus heightened.
60. In addition, personal data stored on vehicles and/or at external locations (e.g., in cloud computing infrastructures) must be adequately secured against unauthorized access. For instance, during maintenance, a vehicle has to be handed to a technician who will require access to some of the vehicle's technical data. While the technician needs to have access to the technical data, there is a possibility that the technician could attempt to access all the data stored in the vehicle.

2 GENERAL RECOMMENDATIONS

61. In order to mitigate the risks for data subjects identified above, the following general recommendations should be followed by vehicle and equipment manufacturers, service providers or any other stakeholder who may act as data controller or data processor in relation to connected vehicles.

2.1 Categories of data

62. As noted in the introduction, most data associated with connected vehicles will be considered personal data to the extent that it is possible to link it to one or more identifiable individuals. This includes technical data concerning the vehicle's movements (e.g., speed, distance travelled) as well concerning the vehicle's condition (e.g., engine coolant temperature, engine RPM, tyre pressure). Certain data generated by connected vehicles may also warrant special attention given their sensitivity and/or potential impact on the rights and interests of data subjects. At present, the EDPB has identified three categories of personal data warranting special attention, by vehicle and equipment manufacturers, service providers and other data controllers: location data, biometric data (and any special category of data as defined in art. 9 GDPR) and data that could reveal offences or traffic violations.

2.1.1 Location data

63. When collecting personal data, vehicle and equipment manufacturers, service providers and other data controllers should keep in mind that location data are particularly revealing of the life habits of data subjects. The journeys carried out are very characteristic in that they

enable one to infer the place of work and of residence, as well as a driver's centres of interest (leisure), and may possibly reveal sensitive information such as religion through the place of worship, or sexual orientation through the places visited. Accordingly, the vehicle and equipment manufacturer, service provider and other data controller should be particularly vigilant not to collect location data except if doing so is absolutely necessary for the purpose of processing. As an example, when the processing consists in detecting the vehicle's movement, the gyroscope is sufficient to fulfil that function, without there being a need to collect location data.

64. In general, collecting location data is also subject to compliance with the following principles:

- Z adequate configuration of the frequency of access to, and of the level of detail of, location data collected relative to the purpose of processing. For example, a weather application should not be able to access the vehicle's location every second, even with the consent of the data subject;
- Z providing accurate information on the purpose of processing (e.g., is location history stored? If so, what is its purpose?);
- Z when the processing is based on consent, obtaining valid (free, specific and informed) consent that is distinct from the general conditions of sale or use, for example on the on-board computer;
- Z activating location only when the user launches a functionality that requires the vehicle's location to be known, and not by default and continuously when the car is started;
- Z informing the user that location has been activated, in particular by using icons (e.g., an arrow that moves across the screen);
- Z the option to deactivate location at any time;
- Z defining a limited storage period.

2.1.2 Biometric data

65. In the context of connected vehicles, biometric data used for the purpose of uniquely identifying a natural person may be processed, within the remit of art. 9 GDPR and the national exceptions, among other things, to enable access to a vehicle, to authenticate the driver/owner, and/or to enable access to a driver's profile settings and preferences. When considering the use of biometric data, guaranteeing the data subject full control over his or her data involves, on the one hand, providing for the existence of a non-biometric alternative (e.g., using a physical key or a code) without additional constraint (that is, the use of biometrics should not be mandatory), and, on the other hand, storing and comparing the biometric template in encrypted form only on a local basis, with biometric data not being processed by an external reading/comparison terminal.

66. In the case of biometric data³⁷, it is important to ensure that the biometric authentication solution is sufficiently reliable, in particular by complying with the following principles:

³⁷ The prohibition principle set out in article 9.1 GDPR only relates to "*biometric data for the purpose of uniquely identifying a natural person*".

- Z the adjustment of the biometric solution used (e.g., the rate of false positives and false negatives) is adapted to the security level of the required access control;
- Z the biometric solution used is based on a sensor that is resistant to attacks (such as the use of a flat-printed print for fingerprint recognition);
- Z the number of authentication attempts is limited;
- Z the biometric template/model is stored in the vehicle, in an encrypted form using a cryptographic algorithm and key management that comply with the state of the art;
- Z the raw data used to make up the biometric template and for user authentication are processed in real time without ever being stored, even locally.

2.1.3 Data revealing criminal offenses or other infractions

67. In order to process data that relate to potential criminal offences within the meaning of art. 10 GDPR, the EDPB recommends to resort to the local processing of the data where the data subject has full control over the processing in question (see discussion on local processing in section 2.4). Indeed – except for some exceptions (see the case study on accidentology studies presented below in section 3.3) – external processing of data revealing criminal offences or other infractions is forbidden. Thus, according to the sensitivity of the data, strong security measures such as those described in section 2.7 must be put in place in order to offer protection against the illegitimate access, modification and deletion of those data.
68. Indeed, some categories of personal data from connected vehicles could reveal that a criminal offence or other infraction has been or is being committed (“offence-related data”) and therefore be subject to special restrictions (e.g., data indicating that the vehicle crossed a white line, the instantaneous speed of a vehicle combined with precise location data). Notably, in the event that such data would be processed by the competent national authorities for the purposes of criminal investigation and prosecution of criminal offence, the safeguards provided for in art. 10 GDPR would apply.

2.2 Purposes

69. Personal data may be processed for a wide variety of purposes in relation to connected vehicles, including driver safety, insurance, efficient transportation, entertainment or information services. In accordance with the GDPR, data controllers must ensure that their purposes are “specified, explicit and legitimate”, not further processed in a way incompatible with those purposes and that there is a valid legal basis for the processing as required in art. 5 GDPR. Some concrete examples of purposes that may be pursued by data controllers operating in the context of connected vehicles are discussed in Part III of these guidelines, along with specific recommendations for each type of processing.

2.3 Relevance and data minimisation

70. To comply with the data minimization principle³⁸, vehicle and equipment manufacturers, service providers and other data controllers should pay special attention to the categories of data they need from a connected vehicle, as they shall only collect personal data that are relevant and necessary for the processing. For instance, location data are particularly intrusive and can reveal many life habits of the data subjects. Accordingly, industry participants should be particularly vigilant not to collect location data except if doing so is

³⁸ GDPR, Article 5(1)(c).

absolutely necessary for the purpose of processing (see discussion on location data above, in section 2.1).

2.4 Data protection by design and by default

71. Taking into account the volume and diversity of personal data produced by connected vehicles, the EDPB notes that data controllers are required to ensure that technologies deployed in the context of connected vehicles are configured to respect the privacy of individuals by applying the obligations of data protection by design and by default as required by art. 25 GDPR. Technologies should be designed to minimize the collection of personal data, provide privacy-protective default settings and ensure that data subjects are well informed and have the option to easily modify configurations associated with their personal data. Specific guidance on how manufacturers and service providers can comply with data protection by design and by default could be beneficial for the industry and third party application providers.
72. Certain general practices, described below, can also help mitigate the risks to the rights and freedoms of natural persons associated with connected vehicles³⁹.

2.4.1 Local processing of personal data

73. In general, vehicle and equipment manufacturers, service providers and other data controllers should, wherever possible, use processes that do not involve personal data or transferring personal data outside of the vehicle (i.e., the data is processed internally). The nature of connected vehicles however does present risks, such as the possibility of attacks on local processing by outside actors or local data being leaked by selling parts of the vehicle. Therefore, adequate attention and security measures should be taken into account to ensure that local processing shall remain local. This scenario offers the advantage of guaranteeing to the user the sole and full control of his/her personal data and, as such, it presents, “by design”, less privacy risks especially by prohibiting any data processing by stakeholders without the data subject knowledge. It also enables the processing of sensitive data such as biometric data or data relating to criminal offenses or other infractions, as well as detailed location data which otherwise would be subject to stricter rules (see below). In the same vein, it presents fewer cybersecurity risks and involves little latency, which makes it particularly suited to automated driving-assistance functions. Some examples of this type of solution could include:
 - Z eco-driving applications that process data in the vehicle in order to display eco-driving advice in real time on the on-board screen;
 - Z applications that involve a transfer of personal data to a device such as a smartphone under the user’s full control (via, for example, Bluetooth or Wi-Fi), and where the vehicle’s data are not transmitted to the application providers or the vehicle manufacturers; this would include, for instance, coupling of smartphones to use the car’s display, multimedia systems, microphone (or other sensors) for phone calls, etc., to the extent that the data collected remain under the control of the data subject and is exclusively used to provide the service he or she has requested;
 - Z in-vehicle safety enhancing applications such as those that provide audible signals or vibrations of the steering wheel when a driver overtakes a car without indicating or straying over white

³⁹ See as well European Data Protection Board, Guidelines 4/2019 on Article 25 Data Protection by Design and by Default, Version 2.0, adopted on 20 October 2020 (hereinafter - “Guidelines 4/2019”).

lines or which provides alerts as to the state of the vehicle (e.g., an alert on the wear and tear affecting brake pads);

- Z applications for unlocking, starting, and/or activating certain vehicle commands using the driver's biometric data that is stored within the vehicle (such as a face or voice models or fingerprint minutiae).

74. Applications such as the above involve processing carried out for the performance of purely personal activities by a natural person (i.e., without the transfer of personal data to a data controller or data processor). Therefore, in accordance with art. 2(2) GDPR, **these applications fall outside the scope of the GDPR.**

75. However, if the GDPR does not apply to the processing of personal data by a natural person in the course of a purely personal or household activity, it does apply to controllers or processors, which provide the means for processing personal data for such personal or household activities (car manufacturers, service provider, etc.) in accordance with recital 18 GDPR. Hence, when they are acting as data controller or data processor, they must develop secure in-car application and with due respect to the principle of privacy by design and by default. In any case, according to recital 78 GDPR, *"When developing, designing, selecting and using applications, services and products that are based on the processing of personal data or process personal data to fulfil their task, producers of the products, services and applications should be encouraged to take into account the right to data protection when developing and designing such products, services and applications and, with due regard to the state of the art, to make sure that controllers and processors are able to fulfil their data protection obligations"*.⁴⁰ On the one hand, it will enhance the development of user-centric services and, on the other hand, it will facilitate and secure any further uses in the future which could fall back within the scope of the GDPR. More specifically, the EDPB recommends developing a secure in-car application platform, physically divided from safety relevant car functions so that the access to car data does not depend on unnecessary external cloud capabilities.

76. Local data processing should be considered by car manufacturers and service providers, whenever possible, to mitigate the potential risks of cloud processing, as they are underlined in the opinion on Cloud Computing released by the Article 29 Working Party.⁴¹

77. In general users should be able to control how their data are collected and processed in the vehicle:

- Z information regarding the processing must be provided in the driver's language (manual, settings, etc.);
- Z the EDPB recommends that only data strictly necessary for the functioning of the vehicle are processed by default. Data subjects should have the possibility to activate or deactivate the data processing for each other purpose and controller/processor and have the possibility to delete the data concerned, taking into account the purpose and the legal basis of the data processing ;

⁴⁰ For more recommendations on privacy by design and privacy by default see also Guidelines 4/2019.

⁴¹ Article 29 Working Party – Opinion 5/2012 on Cloud Computing; https://ec.europa.eu/justice/article-29/documentation/opinion-recommendation/files/2012/wp196_en.pdf.

- Z data should not be transmitted to any third parties (i.e., the user has sole access to the data);
- Z data should be retained only for as long as is necessary for the provision of the service or otherwise required by Union or Member State law;
- Z data subjects should be able to delete permanently any personal data before the vehicles are put up for sale;
- Z data subjects should, where feasible, have a direct access to the data generated by these applications.

78. Finally, while it may not always be possible to resort to local data processing for every use-case, “hybrid processing” can often be put in place. For instance, in the context of usage-based insurance, personal data regarding driving behaviour (such as the force exerted on the brake pedal, mileage driven, etc.) could either be processed inside the vehicle or by the telematics service provider on behalf of the insurance company (the data controller) to generate numerical scores that are transferred to the insurance company on a defined basis (e.g. on a monthly basis). In this way, the insurance company does not gain access to the raw behavioural data but only to the aggregate score that is the result of the processing. This ensures that principles of data minimization are satisfied by design. This also means that users must have the ability to exercise their right when data are stored by other parties: for example, a user should have the ability to delete data stored in the systems of a car maintenance shop or dealership under the conditions of art.17 GDPR.

2.4.2 Anonymization and pseudonymisation

79. If the transmission of personal data outside the vehicle is envisaged, consideration should be given to anonymize them before being transmitted. When anonymising the controller should take into account all processing involved which could potentially lead to re-identification of data, such as the transmission of locally anonymised data. The EDPB recalls that the principles of data protection do not apply to anonymous information, namely information which does not relate to an identified or identifiable natural person or to personal data rendered anonymous in such a manner that the data subject is not or no longer identifiable⁴². Once a dataset is truly anonymised and individuals are no longer identifiable, European data protection law no longer applies. As a consequence, anonymisation, where relevant, may be a good strategy to keep the benefits and to mitigate the risks in relation to connected vehicles.
80. As detailed in the opinion by the Article 29 Working Party on anonymization techniques, various methods can be used – sometimes in combination – in order to reach data anonymisation.⁴³
81. Other techniques such as pseudonymisation⁴⁴ can help minimize the risks generated by the data processing, taking into account that in most cases, directly identifiable data are not necessary to achieve the purpose of the processing. Pseudonymisation, if reinforced by security safeguards, improves the protection of personal data by reducing the risks of

⁴² See GDPR, Article 4 (1) and Recital 26.

⁴³ WP29 - Opinion 05/2014 on Anonymisation Techniques; https://ec.europa.eu/justice/article-29/documentation/opinion-recommendation/files/2014/wp216_en.pdf.

⁴⁴ GDPR, Article 4 (5). Enisa report on December 03, 2019: <https://www.enisa.europa.eu/publications/pseudonymisation-techniques-and-best-practices>.

misuse. Pseudonymisation is reversible, unlike anonymisation, and pseudonymised data are considered as personal data subject to the GDPR.

2.4.3 Data protection impact assessments

82. Given the scale and sensitivity of the personal data that can be generated *via* connected vehicles; it is likely that processing – particularly in situations where personal data are processed outside of the vehicle - will often result in a high risk to the rights and freedoms of individuals. Where this is the case, industry participants will be required to perform a data protection impact assessment (DPIA) to identify and mitigate the risks as detailed in art. 35 and 36 GDPR. Even in the cases where a DPIA is not required, it is a best practice to conduct one as early as possible in the design process. This will allow industry participants to factor the results of this analysis into their design choices prior to the roll-out of new technologies.

2.5 Information

83. Prior to the processing of personal data, the data subject shall be informed of the identity of the data controller (e.g., the vehicle and equipment manufacturer or service provider), the purpose of processing, the data recipients, the period for which data will be stored, and the data subject's rights under the GDPR⁴⁵.
84. In addition, the vehicle and equipment manufacturer, service provider or other data controller should also provide the data subject with the following information, in clear, simple, and easily-accessible terms:
- Z the contact details of the data protection officer;
 - Z the purposes of the processing for which the personal data are intended as well as the legal basis for the processing;
 - Z the explicit mention of the legitimate interests pursued by the data controller or by a third party, when such legitimate interests constitute the legal basis for processing;
 - Z the recipients or categories of recipients of the personal data, if any;
 - Z the period for which the personal data will be stored, or if that is not possible, the criteria used to determine that period;
 - Z the existence of the right to request from the controller access to and rectification or erasure of personal data or restriction of processing concerning the data subject or to object to processing as well as the right to data portability;
 - Z the existence of the right to withdraw consent at any time without affecting the lawfulness of processing based on consent before its withdrawal where the processing is based on consent;
 - Z where applicable, the fact that the controller intends to transfer personal data to a third country or international organisation and safeguards used to transfer them;
 - Z whether the provision of personal data is a statutory or contractual requirement, or a requirement necessary to enter into a contract, as well as whether the data subject is obliged to provide the personal data and of the possible consequences of failure to provide such data;

⁴⁵ GDPR, Article 5 (1) (a) and 13. See also Article 29 Working Party, Guidelines on Transparency under Regulation 2016/679 (wp260rev.01), endorsed by the EDPB.

- Z the existence of automated decision-making, including profiling that produces legal effects concerning the data subject or similarly significantly affects the data subject, and meaningful information about the logic involved, as well as the significance and the envisaged consequences of such processing for the data subject. This could particularly be the case in relation to the provision of usage-based insurance to individuals;
- Z the right to lodge a complaint with a supervisory authority;
- Z information about further processing;
- Z In case of joint data controllership, clear and complete information about the responsibilities of each data controller.

85. In some cases, personal data is not collected directly from the individual concerned. For instance, a vehicle and equipment manufacturer may rely on a dealer to collect information about the owner of the vehicle in order to offer an emergency road side assistance service. When data have not been collected directly, the vehicle and equipment manufacturer, service provider or other data controller shall, in addition to the information mentioned above, also indicate the categories of personal data concerned, the source from which the personal data originate, and, if applicable, whether those data came from publicly accessible sources. That information must be provided by the controller within a reasonable period after obtaining the data, and **no later than the first of the following dates** in accordance with art. 14 (3) GDPR: (i) one month after the data are obtained, having regard to the specific circumstances in which the personal data are processed, (ii) upon first communication with the data subject, or (iii) if those data are transmitted to a third party, before the transmission of the data.
86. New information may also need to be provided to data subjects when they are taken care of by new data controller. A roadside assistance service that interacts with connected vehicles can be provided by different data controllers depending in which country or region the assistance is required. New data controllers should provide data subjects with the required information when data subjects cross borders and services that interact with connected vehicles are provided by new data controllers.
87. The information directed to the data subjects may be provided in layers⁴⁶, i.e. by separating two levels of information: on the one hand, first-level information, which is the most important for the data subjects, and, on the other hand, information that presumably is of interest at a later stage. The essential first-level information includes, in addition to the identity of the data controller, the purpose of the processing and a description of the data subject's rights, as well as any additional information on the processing which has the most impact on the data subject and processing which could surprise them. The EDPB recommends that, in the context of connected vehicles, the data subject should be made aware of all the recipients in the first layer of information. As stated in the WP29 guidelines on transparency, controllers should provide information on the recipients that is most meaningful for data subjects. In practice, this will generally be the named recipients, so that data subjects know exactly who has their personal data. If controllers cannot provide the names of the recipients, the information should be as specific as possible by indicating the

⁴⁶ See Article 29 Working Party, Guidelines on Transparency under Regulation 2016/679 (wp260rev.01), endorsed by the EDPB.

type of recipient (i.e. by reference to the activities it carries out), the industry, sector and sub-sector, and the location of the recipients.

88. The data subjects may be informed by concise and easily understandable clauses in the contract of sale of the vehicle, in the contract for the provision of services, and/or in any written medium, by using distinct documents (e.g., the vehicle's maintenance record book or manual) or the on-board computer.
89. Standardised icons could be used in addition to the information necessary, as required under art. 13 and 14 GDPR, to enhance transparency by potentially reducing the need for vast amounts of written information to be presented to a data subject. It should be visible in vehicles in order to provide, in relation to the planned processing, a good overview that is understandable, and clearly legible. The EDPB emphasises the importance of standardising those icons, so that the user finds the same symbols regardless of the make or model of the vehicle. For example, when certain types of data are being collected, such as location, the vehicles could have a clear signal on-board (such as a light inside the vehicle) to inform passengers about data collection.

2.6 Rights of the data subject

90. Vehicle and equipment manufacturers, service providers and other data controllers should facilitate data subjects' control over their data during the entire processing period, through the implementation of specific tools providing an effective way to exercise their rights, in particular their right of access, rectification, erasure, their right to restrict the processing and, depending on the legal basis of the processing, their right to data portability and their right to object.
91. To facilitate settings modifications, a profile management system should be implemented in order to store the preferences of known drivers and help them to change easily their privacy settings anytime. The profile management system should centralize every data setting for each data processing, especially to facilitate the access, deletion, removal and portability of personal data from vehicle systems at the request of the data subject. Drivers should be enabled to stop the collection of certain types of data, temporarily or permanently, at any moment, unless there is a specific legal ground that the controller can rely on to continue the collection of specific data. In case of a contract that provides a personalized offer based on driving behaviour this may mean that the user as a result should be reverted to the standard conditions of that contract. These features should be implemented inside the vehicle, although it could also be provided to data subjects through additional means (e.g., dedicated application). Furthermore, in order to allow data subjects to quickly and easily remove personal data that can be stored on the car's dashboard (for example, GPS navigation history, web browsing, etc.), the EDPB recommends that manufacturers provide a simple functionality (such as a delete button).
92. The sale of a connected vehicle and the ensuing change of ownership should also trigger the deletion of any personal data, which is no longer needed for the previous specified purposes and the data subject should be able to exercise his or her right to portability.

2.7 Security

93. Vehicle and equipment manufacturers, service providers and other data controllers should put in place measures that guarantee the security and confidentiality of processed data and

take all useful precautions to prevent control being taken by an unauthorised person. In particular, industry participants should consider adopting the following measures:

- Z encrypting the communication channels by means of a state-of-the-art algorithm;
- Z putting in place an encryption-key management system that is unique to each vehicle, not to each model;
- Z when stored remotely, encrypting data by means of state-of-the-art algorithms;
- Z regularly renewing encryption keys;
- Z protecting encryption keys from any disclosure;
- Z authenticating data-receiving devices;
- Z ensuring data integrity (e.g., by hashing);
- Z make access to personal data subject to reliable user authentication techniques (password, electronic certificate, etc.);

94. Concerning more specifically vehicle manufacturers, the EDPB recommends the implementation of the following security measures:

- Z partitioning the vehicle's vital functions from those always relying on telecommunication capacities (e.g., "infotainment");
- Z implementing technical measures that enable vehicle manufacturers to rapidly patch security vulnerabilities during the entire lifespan of the vehicle;
- Z for the vehicle's vital functions, give priority as much as possible to using secure means of communications that are specifically dedicated to transportation;
- Z setting up an alarm system in case of attack on the vehicle's systems, with the possibility of operating in downgraded mode⁴⁷;
- Z storing a log history of any access to the vehicle's information system, e.g. going back six months as a maximum period, in order to enable the origin of any potential attack to be understood and periodically carry out a review of the logged information to detect possible anomalies.

95. These general recommendations should be completed by specific requirements taking into account the characteristics and purpose of each data processing.

2.8 Transmitting personal data to third parties

96. In principle, only the data controller and the data subject have access to the data generated by a connected vehicle. However, the data controller may transmit personal data to a commercial partner (recipient), to the extent that such transmission lawfully relies on one of the legal bases stated in art. 6 GDPR.

⁴⁷ Downgraded mode is a vehicle operating mode ensuring that the functions essential for the safe operation of the vehicle (i.e., minimum safety requirements) would be guaranteed, even if other less important functionalities would be deactivated (e.g., the operation of the geo-guidance device can be considered as non-essential, as opposed to the braking system).

97. In view of the possible sensitivity of the vehicle-usage data (e.g., journeys made, driving style), the EDPB recommends that the data subject's consent be systematically obtained before their data are transmitted to a commercial partner acting as a data controller (e.g., by ticking a box that is not pre-ticked, or, where technically possible, by using a physical or logical device that the person can access from the vehicle). The commercial partner in turn becomes responsible for the data that it receives, and is subject to all the provisions of the GDPR.
98. The vehicle manufacturer, service provider or other data controller can transmit personal data to a data processor selected to play a part in providing the service to the data subject, provided the data processor shall not use those data for its own purpose. Data controllers and data processors shall draw up a contract or other legal document specifying the obligations of each party and setting out the provisions of art. 28 GDPR.

2.9 Transfer of personal data outside the EU/EEA

99. When personal data is transferred outside the European Economic Area, special safeguards are foreseen to ensure that the protection travels with the data.
100. As a consequence, the data controller may transfer personal data to a recipient only to the extent that such transfer is in accordance with the requirements laid down in Chapter V GDPR.

2.10 Use of in-vehicle Wi-Fi technologies

101. Advances in cellular technology have made it possible to easily use the Internet on the road. While it is possible to get Wi-Fi connectivity in a vehicle through a smartphone hotspot or a dedicated device (OBD-II dongle, wireless modem or router, etc.), most manufacturers offer nowadays models that include a built-in cellular data connection and are also capable of creating Wi-Fi networks. Depending on the case, various aspects must be considered:

ZThe Wi-Fi connectivity is offered as a service by a road professional, such as a taxi driver for its customers. In this case, the professional or his/her company might be considered as an internet service provider (ISP), hence be subject to specific obligations and restrictions regarding the processing of his / her clients' personal data.

ZThe Wi-Fi connectivity is put in place for the sole use of the driver (at the exclusion of the driver and his/her passengers). In this case, the processing of personal data is considered to be purely personal or household activity in accordance with art. 2(2)(c) and recital 18 GDPR.

102. In general, the proliferation of Internet connection interfaces via Wi-Fi poses greater risks to the privacy of individuals. Indeed, through their vehicles, users become continuous broadcasters, and can therefore be identified and tracked. In order to prevent tracking, easy to operate opt-out options ensuring the service set identifier (SSID) of the on-board Wi-Fi network is not collected should therefore be put in place by the vehicle and equipment manufacturers.

3 CASE STUDIES

103. This section addresses five specific examples of processing in the context of connected vehicles, which correspond to scenarios likely to be encountered by stakeholders in the sector. The examples cover data processing that requires calculating power which cannot be mobilised locally in the vehicle, and/or the sending of personal data to a third party to carry out further analysis or to provide further functionality remotely. For each type of processing, this document specifies the intended purposes, the categories of data collected, the retention period of such data, the rights of data subjects, the security measures to be implemented, and the recipients of the information. In the case some of these fields are not described in the following, the general recommendations described in the previous part apply.
104. The examples chosen are non-exhaustive and are meant to be indicative of the variety of types of processing, legal bases, actors, etc. that might be engaged in the context of connected vehicles.

3.1 Provision of a service by a third party

105. Data subjects may contract with a service provider in order to obtain added-value services relating to their vehicle. For example, a data subject may enter into a usage-based insurance contract that offers reduced insurance premiums for less driving ("Pay As You Drive") or good driving behaviour ("Pay How You Drive") and which necessitates monitoring of driving habits by the insurance company. A data subject could also contract with a company that offers roadside assistance in the event of a breakdown and which entails the transmission of the vehicle's location to the company or with a service provider in order to receive

messages or alerts relating to the vehicle's functioning (e.g., an alert on the state of brake wear, or a reminder of the technical-inspection date).

3.1.1 Usage-based insurance

106. "Pay as you drive" is a type of usage-based insurance that tracks the driver's mileage and/or driving habits to differentiate and reward "safe" drivers by giving them lower premiums. The insurer will require the driver to install a built-in telematics service, a mobile application or activate a built-in module from manufacturing that tracks the miles covered and/or the driving behaviour (braking pattern, rapid acceleration, etc.) of the policy holder. The information gathered by the telematic device will be used to assign the driver scores in order to analyse what risks he/she may pose to the insurance company.
107. As usage-based insurance requires consent under art. 5(3) of the ePrivacy directive, the EDPB outlines that the policy holder must have the choice to subscribe to a non-usage-based insurance policy. Otherwise, consent would not be considered freely given, as the performance of the contract would be conditional on the consent. Further, art. 7(3) GDPR requires that a data subject must have the right to withdraw consent.

3.1.1.1 Legal basis

108. When the data is collected through a publicly available electronic communication service (for example *via* the SIM card contained in the telematics device), consent will be needed in order to gain access to information that is already stored in the vehicle as provided by art. 5(3) ePrivacy directive. Indeed, none of the exemptions provided by those provisions can apply in this context: the processing is not for the sole purpose of carrying out the transmission of a communication over an electronic communications network nor does it relate to an information society service explicitly requested by the subscriber or user. Consent could be collected at the time of the conclusion of the contract.
109. As regards the processing of personal data following the storage or access to the end-user's terminal equipment, the insurance company can rely on art. 6(1)(b) GDPR in this specific context provided it can establish both that the processing takes place in the context of a valid contract with the data subject and that processing is necessary in order that the particular contract with the data subject can be performed. Insofar as the processing is objectively necessary for the performance of the contract with the data subject, the EDPB considers that reliance upon art. 6(1)(b) GDPR would not have the effect of lowering the additional protection provided by art. 5(3) of the ePrivacy directive in this specific instance. That legal basis is materialised by the data subject signing a contract with the insurance company.

3.1.1.2 Data collected

110. There are two types of personal data to be considered:
 - Z **commercial and transactional data:** data subject's identifying information, transaction-related data, data relating to means of payment, etc.;
 - Z **usage data:** personal data generated by the vehicle, driving habits, location, etc.
111. The EDPB recommends that, as far as possible, and given that there is a risk that the data collected via the telematics-box could be misused to create a precise profile of the driver's movements, raw data regarding driving behaviour should be either processed:

- Z inside the vehicle in telematics boxes or in the user's smartphone so that the insurer only accesses the results data (e.g., a score relating to driving habits), not detailed raw data (see section 2.1);
 - Z or by the telematics service provider on behalf of the controller (the insurance company) to generate numerical scores that are transferred to the insurance company on a defined basis. In this case, raw data and data directly relating to the identity of the driver must be separated. This means that the telematics service provider receives the real-time data, but does not know the names, licence plates, etc. of the policy holders. On the other hand, the insurer knows the names of policyholders, but only receives the scores and the total kilometres and not the raw data used to produce such scores.
112. Moreover, it has to be noted that if only the mileage is necessary for the performance of the contract, location data shall not be collected.

3.1.1.3 *Retention period*

113. In the context of data processing taking place for the performance of a contract (i.e. provision of a service), it is important to distinguish between two types of data before defining their respective retention periods:
- Z **commercial and transactional data:** those data can be retained in an active database for the full duration of the contract. At the end of the contract, they can be archived physically (on a separate medium: DVD, etc.) or logically (by authorisation management) in the event of possible litigation. Thereafter, at the end of the statutory limitation periods, the data shall be deleted or anonymised;
 - Z **usage data:** usage data can be classified as raw data and aggregated data. As stated above, if possible, data controllers or processors should not process raw data. If it is necessary, raw data should be kept only as long as they are required to elaborate the aggregated data and to check the validity of that aggregation process. Aggregated data should be kept as long as it is necessary for the provision of the service or otherwise requested by a Union or Member State law.

3.1.1.4 *Information and rights of data subjects*

114. Prior to the processing of personal data, the data subject shall be informed according to art. 13 GDPR, in a transparent and understandable way. In particular, he or she must be informed of the period for which the personal data will be stored, or if that is not possible, the criteria used to determine that period. In this last case, the EDPB recommends to adopt a pedagogic approach to emphasize the difference between raw data and the score produced on this basis, stressing, when it is the case, that the insurer will only collect the result of the score where appropriate.
115. Where data are not processed inside the vehicle but by a telematics provider on behalf of the controller (the insurance company), the information could usefully mention that, in this case, the provider will not have access to data directly relating to the identity of the driver (such as names, licence plates, etc.). Also, considering the importance of informing data subjects as to the consequences of processing of their personal data and the fact that data subjects should not be taken by surprise by the processing of their personal data, the EDPB recommends that data subject should be informed of the existence of profiling and the consequences of such profiling even if it does not involve any automated decision-making as referred to in art. 22 GDPR.

116. Regarding the right of data subjects, they shall be specifically informed of the available means to exercise his or her right of access, rectification, restriction and erasure. Since raw data collected in this context are provided by the data subject (through specific forms or through his or her activity) and processed on the basis of art. 6(1)(b) GDPR (performance of a contract), the data subject is entitled to exercise his or her right to data portability. As emphasized in the guidelines on the right to data portability, the EDPB strongly recommends “that data controllers clearly explain the difference between the types of data that a data subject can receive through the rights of subject access and data portability”.⁴⁸
117. The information can be provided when the contract is signed.

3.1.1.5 Recipient:

118. The EDPB recommends that, as far as possible, the vehicle’s usage data should be processed directly in telematics boxes, so that the insurer only accesses the results data (e.g. a score), not detailed raw data.
119. If a telematics service provider collects the data on behalf of the controller (the insurance company) to generate numerical scores, it does not need to know the identity of the driver (such as names, licence plates, etc.) of the policy holders.

3.1.1.6 Security:

120. General recommendations apply. See section 2.7.

3.1.2 Renting and booking a parking space

121. The owner of a parking place may want to rent it. For this, he/she lists a spot and sets a price for it on a web application. Then, once the parking spot is listed, the application notifies the owner when a driver wants to book it. The driver can select a destination and check for available parking spots based on multiple criteria. After the approval of the owner, the transaction is confirmed and the service provider handles the payment transaction then uses navigation to drive to the location.

3.1.2.1 Legal basis

122. When the data is collected through a publicly available electronic communication, art. 5(3) of the ePrivacy directive applies.
123. Because this is an information society service, art. 5(3) of the ePrivacy directive does not require consent for gaining access to information that is already stored in the vehicle when such a service is explicitly requested by the subscriber.
124. For the processing of personal data and only for data necessary for the performance of the contract to which the data subject is party, art. 6(1)(b) GDPR will be the legal basis.

3.1.2.2 Data collected

125. Data processed includes the driver contact details (name, email, telephone number, vehicle type (e.g. car, truck, motorcycle), license plate number, parking period, payment details (e.g. credit card info) as well as navigation data.

⁴⁸ Article 29 Working Party, Guidelines on the right to data portability under Regulation 2016/676, WP242 rev.01, endorsed by EDPB, p. 13.

3.1.2.3 Retention period

126. Data should be retained only as long as it is necessary to fulfil the parking contract or otherwise as provided by Union or Member State law. After that data is either anonymised or deleted.

3.1.2.4 Information and rights of data subjects

127. Prior to the processing of personal data, the data subject should be informed according to art. 13 GDPR, in a transparent and understandable way.
128. The data subject should be specifically informed of the available means to exercise his or her right of access, rectification, restriction and erasure. Since the data collected in this context are provided by the data subject (through specific forms or through his or her activity) and processed on the basis of art. 6(1)(b) GDPR (performance of a contract), the data subject is entitled to exercise his or her right to data portability. As emphasized in the guidelines on the right to data portability, the EDPB strongly recommends *“that data controllers clearly explain the difference between the types of data that a data subject can receive through the rights of subject access and data portability”*.

3.1.2.5 Recipient:

129. In principle, only the data controller and the data processor have access to the data.

3.1.2.6 Security:

130. General recommendations apply. See section 2.7.

3.2 eCall

131. In the event of a serious accident in the European Union, the vehicle automatically triggers an eCall to 112, the EU-wide emergency number (see section 1.1 for further details) which allows an ambulance to be sent the place of the accident promptly according to Regulation (EU) 2015/758 of 29 April 2015 concerning type-approval requirements for the deployment of the eCall in-vehicle system based on the 112 service, and amending Directive 2007/46/EC (hereinafter - “Regulation (EU) 2015/758”).
132. Indeed, the eCall generator installed inside the vehicle, which enables transmission via a public mobile wireless communications network initiates an emergency call, which is either triggered automatically by vehicle sensors or manually by the vehicle occupants only in the event of an accident. In addition to activation of the audio channel, the second event triggered automatically as a result of an accident consists in generating the Minimum Set of Data (MSD) and sending it to the public safety answering point (PSAP).

3.2.1 Legal basis

133. Regarding the application of the ePrivacy directive, two provisions have to be considered:
 - Z art. 9 regarding location data other than traffic data which only applies to electronic communication services;
 - Z art. 5(3) for the gaining access to information stored in the generator installed inside the vehicle.
134. Despite the fact that, in principle, those provisions require the consent of the data subject, Regulation (EU) 2015/758 constitutes a legal obligation to which the data controller is subject (the data subject has no genuine or free choice and will be unable to refuse the

processing of his/her data). Hence, Regulation (EU) 2015/758 overrides the need of the driver's consent for the processing of location data and the MSD.⁴⁹

135. The legal basis of the processing of those data will be compliance with a legal obligation as provided for in art. 6(1)(c) GDPR (i.e., Regulation (EU) 2015/758).

3.2.2 Data collected

136. Regulation (EU) 2015/578 provides that data sent by the 112-based eCall in-vehicle system shall include only the minimum information as referred to in the standard EN 15722:2015 'Intelligent transport systems — eSafety — eCall minimum set of data (MSD)' including:

- Z the indication if eCall has been manually or automatically triggered;
- Z the vehicle type;
- Z the vehicle identification number (VIN);
- Z the propulsion type of the vehicle;
- Z the timestamp of the initial data message generation within the current eCall incident event;
- Z the last known vehicle latitude and longitude position determined at the latest moment possible before message generation;
- Z the vehicle's last known real direction of travel determined at the latest moment possible before message generation (only the last three locations of the vehicle).

3.2.3 Retention period

137. Regulation (EU) 2015/758 stipulates that data shall not be retained for longer than is needed for processing emergency situations. Those data shall be completely deleted when they are no longer needed for that purpose. Furthermore, in the internal memory of the eCall system, data shall be automatically and constantly deleted. Only the vehicle's last three positions can be stored, insofar as it is strictly necessary to specify the current position of the vehicle and the direction of travel at the time of the event.

3.2.4 Information and rights of data subjects

138. Art. 6 of the Regulation (EU) 2015/758 stipulates that manufacturers shall provide clear and complete information on data processing done using the eCall system. This information shall be provided in the owner's manual separately for the 112-based eCall in-vehicle system and any third-party service supported eCall systems prior to the use of the system. It includes:

- Z the reference to the legal basis for the processing;
- Z the fact that the 112-based eCall in-vehicle system is activated by default;
- Z the arrangements for data processing that the 112-based eCall in-vehicle system performs;

⁴⁹ It has to be noted that Article 8-1-f of the Council negotiation mandate for the proposal for an "ePrivacy" regulation does provide a specific exemption for eCall as consent is not needed when *"it is necessary to locate terminal equipment when an end-user makes an emergency communication either to the single European emergency number '112' or a national emergency number, in accordance with Article 13(3)."*

- Z the specific purpose of the eCall processing, which shall be limited to the emergency situations referred to in the first subparagraph of Art. 5(2) Regulation (EU) 2015/758;
 - Z the types of data collected and processed and the recipients of that data;
 - Z the time limit for the retention of data in the 112-based eCall in-vehicle system;
 - Z the fact that there is no constant tracking of the vehicle;
 - Z the arrangements for exercising data subjects' rights as well as the contact service responsible for handling access requests;
 - Z any necessary additional information regarding traceability, tracking and processing of personal data in relation to the provision of a third-party service (TPS) eCall and/or other added value services, which shall be subject to explicit consent by the owner and in compliance with the GDPR. Particular account shall be taken of the fact that differences may exist between the data processing carried out through the 112-based eCall in-vehicle system and the TPS eCall in-vehicle systems or other added value services.
139. Furthermore, the service provider shall also provide the data subjects with information in accordance with art. 13 GDPR in a transparent and understandable way. In particular, he or she must be informed of the purposes of the processing for which the personal data are intended as well as the fact that the processing of personal data is based on a legal obligation to which the controller is subject.
140. In addition, taking into account the nature of the processing, the information about the recipients or categories of recipients of the personal data should be clear and the data subjects should be informed that the data are not be available outside the 112-based eCall in-vehicle system to any entities before the eCall is triggered.
141. Regarding rights of data subjects, it has to be noted that since the processing is based on a legal obligation, the right to object and the right to portability will not apply.

3.2.5 Recipient:

142. The data shall not be available outside the 112-based eCall in-vehicle system to any entities before the eCall is triggered.
143. When it is triggered (either manually by vehicle occupants or automatically as soon as an in-vehicle sensor detects a serious collision), the eCall system establishes a voice connection with the relevant PSAP and the MSD is sent to the PSAP operator.
144. Furthermore, data transmitted via the 112-based eCall in-vehicle system and processed by the PSAPs can be transferred to the emergency service and service partners referred to in Decision No 585/2014/EU only in the event of incidents related to eCalls and under the conditions set out in that Decision and are used exclusively for the attainment of the objectives of that Decision. Data processed by the PSAPs through the 112-based eCall in-vehicle system are not transferred to any other third parties without the explicit prior consent of the data subject.

3.2.6 Security

145. Regulation (EU) 2015/758 stipulates the requirements to incorporate into the eCall system technologies that strengthen the protection of privacy, in order to offer users the appropriate level of protection of privacy, as well as the guarantees needed to prevent

surveillance and abusive uses. In addition, manufacturers should ensure that the eCall system based on the number 112, as well as any other system providing an eCall that is handled by third-party services or an added-value service, are so designed that it is impossible for personal data to be exchanged between those systems.

146. Regarding PSAPs, Member States should ensure that personal data are protected against misuse, including unlawful access, alteration or loss, and that protocols concerning personal data storage, retention duration, processing and protection are established at the appropriate level and properly observed.

3.3 Accidentology studies

147. Data subjects may voluntarily agree to take part in accidentology studies aimed at better understanding the causes of road accidents and more generally scientific purposes.

3.3.1 Legal basis

148. When the data are collected through a public electronic communication service, the data controller will have to collect the consent of the data subject for the gaining of access to information that is already stored in the vehicle as provided by art. 5(3) of the ePrivacy directive. Indeed, none of the exemptions provided by those provisions can apply in this context: the processing is not for the sole purpose of carrying out the transmission of a communication over an electronic communications network nor does it relate to an information society service explicitly requested by the subscriber or user.
149. Regarding the processing of personal data and taking into account the variety and amount of personal data needed for accidentology studies, the EDPB recommends the processing to be based on the prior consent of the data subject according to art. 6 GDPR. Such prior consent must be provided on a specific form, through which the data subject volunteers to take part to the study and have his or her personal data processed for that purpose. Consent shall be an expression of the free, specific, and informed will of the person whose data are being processed (e.g., ticking a box that is not pre-ticked, or configuring the onboard computer to activate a function in the vehicle). Such consent must be provided separately, for specific purposes, may not be bundled with the contract to buy or lease a new car and the consent must be as easily withdrawn as it is given. Withdrawal of consent shall lead to the processing being stopped. The data shall then be deleted from the active database, or anonymised.
150. Consent required by art. 5(3) of the ePrivacy directive and consent needed as a legal basis for the processing of data can be collected at the same time (for example by checking a box clearly indicating what the data subject is consenting to).
151. It has to be noted that, depending on the conditions of the processing (nature of the data controller, etc.), another legal basis can be lawfully chosen as long as it does not lower the additional protection provided by art. 5(3) ePrivacy directive (see paragraph 15). If the processing is based on another legal basis such as the performance of a task carried out in the public interest (art. 6(1)(e) GDPR), the EDPB recommends that the data subjects are included in the study on a voluntary basis.

3.3.2 Data collected

152. The data controller shall only collect personal data that are strictly necessary for the processing.

153. There are two types of data to be considered:

Z data relating to participants and vehicles ;

Z technical data from vehicles (instantaneous speed, etc.).

154. Scientific research linked to accidentology justifies the collection of the instantaneous speed, including by legal persons who do not administer a public service in the strict sense.

155. Indeed, as noted above, the EDPB considers that instantaneous speed collected in the context of an accidentology study is not offence-related data by destination (i.e., it is not being collected for the purpose of investigating or prosecuting an offence), which justifies its collection by legal persons who do not administer a public service in the strict sense.

3.3.3 Retention period

156. It is important to distinguish between two types of data. First, the data relating to participants and vehicles can be retained for the duration of the study. Second, the technical data from vehicles should be retained for as short as possible for the purpose. In this regard, five years from the end date of the study appears to be a reasonable period. At the end of that period, the data shall be deleted or anonymised.

3.3.4 Information and rights of data subjects

157. Prior to the processing of personal data, the data subject shall be informed according to art. 13 GDPR, in a transparent and understandable way. In particular, in the case of collecting instantaneous speed, the data subjects should be specifically informed of the data collection. Since the data processing is based on consent, the data subject must be specifically informed of the existence of the right to withdraw consent at any time, without affecting the lawfulness of processing based on consent before its withdrawal. Moreover, because the data collected in this context are provided by the data subject (through specific forms or through his or her activity) and processed on the basis of art. 6(1)(a) GDPR (consent), the data subject is entitled to exercise his or her right to data portability. As emphasized in the guidelines on the right to data portability, the EDPB strongly recommends “that data controllers clearly explain the difference between the types of data that a data subject can receive through the rights of subject access and data portability”. Consequently, the data controller should provide an easy way to withdraw his consent, freely and at any time, as well as develop tools to be able to answer data portability requests.

158. That information can be given upon signing the form to agree to take part in the accidentology study.

3.3.5 Recipient

159. In principle, only the data controller and the data processor have access to the data.

3.3.6 Security

160. As noted above, the security measures put in place shall be adapted to the level of data sensitivity. For instance, if instantaneous speed (or any other data related to criminal convictions and offences) is collected as part of the accidentology study, the EDPB strongly recommends putting in place strong security measures, such as:

Z implementing pseudonymisation measures (e.g., secret-key hashing of data like the surname/first name of the data subject and the serial number);

- Z storing data relating to instantaneous speed and to location in separate databases (e.g., using a state-of-the-art encryption mechanism with distinct keys and approval mechanisms);
- Z and/or deleting location data as soon as the reference event or sequence is qualified (e.g., the type of road, day/night), and the storage of directly-identifying data in a separate database that can only be accessed by a small number of people.

3.4 Tackle auto theft

- 161. Data subjects may wish, in the case of theft, to attempt to find their vehicle using location. Using location data is limited to the strict needs of the investigation and to the case assessment by the competent legal authorities.

3.4.1 Legal basis

- 162. When the data is collected through a publicly available electronic communication service, art. 5(3) of the ePrivacy directive applies.
- 163. Because this is an information society service, art. 5(3) of the ePrivacy directive does not require consent for gaining access to information that is already stored in the vehicle when such a service is explicitly requested by the subscriber.
- 164. Regarding the processing of personal data, the legal basis for processing the location data will be the consent of the vehicle's owner, or, if applicable, the performance of a contract (only for data necessary for the performance of the contract to which the vehicle's owner is party).
- 165. Consent shall be an expression of the free, specific, and informed will of the person whose data are being processed (e.g. ticking a box that is not pre-ticked, or configuring the on-board computer to activate a function in the vehicle). Freedom to give consent involves the option of withdrawing consent at any time, of which the data subject should be expressly informed. Withdrawal of consent shall lead to the processing being stopped. The data should then be deleted from the active database, anonymised, or archived.

3.4.2 Data collected

- 166. Location data can only be transmitted as of the declaration of theft, and cannot be collected continuously the rest of the time.

3.4.3 Retention period

- 167. Location data can only be retained for the period during which the case is assessed by the competent legal authorities, or until the end of a procedure to dispel doubt that does not end with confirmation of the theft of the vehicle.

3.4.4 Information of the data subjects

- 168. Prior to the processing of personal data, the data subject should be informed according to art. 13 GDPR, in a transparent and understandable way. More specifically, the EDPB recommends that the data controller emphasizes that there is no constant tracking of the vehicle and that location data can only be collected and transmitted as of the declaration of theft. Moreover, the controller must provide the data subject with information relating to the fact that only approved officers of the remote-surveillance platform and legally approved authorities have access to the data.
- 169. Regarding the rights of the data subjects, when the data processing is based on consent, the data subject should be specifically informed of the existence of the right to withdraw

consent at any time, without affecting the lawfulness of processing based on consent before its withdrawal. Besides, when the data collected in this context are provided by them (through specific forms or through his or her activity) and processed on the basis of art. 6(1)(a) (consent) or art. 6(1)(b) GDPR (performance of a contract), the data subject is entitled to exercise his or her right to data portability. As emphasized in the guidelines on the right to data portability, the EDPB strongly recommends “that data controllers clearly explain the difference between the types of data that a data subject can receive through the rights of subject access and data portability”.

170. Consequently, the data controller should provide an easy way to withdraw his consent (only when consent is the legal basis), freely and at any time, as well as develop tools to be able to answer data portability requests.

171. The information can be provided when the contract is signed.

3.4.5 Recipients

172. In the event of a theft declaration, location data can be passed on the (i) approved officers of the remote-surveillance platform, and (ii) to the legally approved authorities.

3.4.6 Security

173. General recommendations apply. See section 2.7